

Delving Deeper Monster Matrices

Delving Deeper is a retroclone of the original 1974 edition of the fantasy role-playing game, written by Simon J. Bull and published by Immersive Ink (ddo.immersiveink.com). This document is modelled on Dan Collins's OED handouts of the same name (oedgames.com). Every value comes from `MonsterDatabase-DelvingDeeper.csv`, an Arena monster database of the Delving Deeper reference rules; the Equivalent Hit Dice (EHD) were computed by running Dan's Arena combat simulator on the Delving Deeper statistics. The database and the script that produced this document live in github.com/karsalfrink/Arena, directory `tools/delving-deeper/`; the database is proposed upstream in [danielrcollins1/Arena pull request 6](https://github.com/danielrcollins1/Arena/pull/6). The database and this document were produced with a large language model (Anthropic's Claude) under the review of Kars Alfrink; the README in that directory says how. The Monster Level Matrix is Dan's (Arena's `MonsterLevelMatrix.csv`). The Monster Level Tables are rebuilt from the Delving Deeper EHDs with Arena's banding (`EHDToTable.csv`): only dungeon monsters (Env D) with an EHD of 1 or more are listed, and monster families are collapsed into one entry as described under *Notes*. Generated from `MonsterDatabase-DelvingDeeper.csv` at commit 5d6cad5 (7 September 2026).

Monster Level Matrix

Dungeon level	Monster level					
	1	2	3	4	5	6
1	1–4	5	6	–	–	–
2	1–2	3–4	5	6	–	–
3–4	1	2	3–4	5	6	–
5–7	–	1	2	3–4	5	6
8–10	–	–	1	2	3–4	5–6
11+	–	–	–	1	2	3–6

Roll 1d6 on the row for the dungeon level; the result gives the monster level table to use.

Monster Level Tables

Level 1 (EHD 1)

d14	Monster
1	Ants, giant
2	Gnolls
3	Goblins
4	Hobgoblins
5	Kobolds
6	Lizardmen
7	Lizards, large
8	Men, Bandits
9	Orcs
10	Rats, giant
11	Skeletons
12	Snakes, large
13	Spiders, large
14	Zombies

Level 3 (EHD 3–4)

d16	Monster
1	Androids
2	Cyborgs
3	Doppelgangers
4	Gargoyles
5	Ghouls
6	Giant Beetle (4–7 HD)
7	Gray ooze
8	Lycanthrope (Boar/Tiger/Bear)
9	Minotaurs
10	Ochre jelly
11	Ogres
12	Thulls
13	Toads, giant
14	Wight apes
15	Wights
16	Wraiths

Level 2 (EHD 2)

d7	Monster
1	Bats, giant
2	Centipedes, large
3	Giant Beetle (2–3 HD)
4	Lizards, giant
5	Lycanthrope (Wolf)
6	Shadows
7	Weasels, giant

Level 4 (EHD 5–7)

d15	Monster
1	Centipedes, giant
2	Cockatrices
3	Gelatinous cube
4	Green slime
5	Hydra (5 heads)
6	Manticoras
7	Mummies
8	Robots
9	Scorpions, giant
10	Snakes, giant (constrictor)
11	Snakes, giant (viper)
12	Spectres
13	Spiders, giant
14	Trolls
15	Yellow mold

Level 5 (EHD 8–10)

d4	Monster
1	Giant (Hill/Stone/Frost)
2	Hydra (6–7 heads)
3	Salamanders
4	Wyverns

Level 6 (EHD 11+)

d15	Monster
1	Basilisks
2	Black pudding
3	Chimeras
4	Dragon (Any)
5	Giant (Fire/Cloud/Storm)
6	Golem (Flesh/Clay)
7	Gorgons
8	Gothrogs
9	Hydra (8–12 heads)
10	Juggernaut
11	Living Statue (Stone/Iron)
12	Medusae
13	Purple worms
14	Titan
15	Vampires

Roll the die shown, or a larger die and roll again on a result above the table.

Number Appearing

Assume a party of four characters. Wandering monsters appear 1d3 at a time (average 2), on the assumption that dungeon level equates to Equivalent Hit Dice. If the matrix cell rolled lies in the column that contains the 3–4 result for that dungeon level, use the number as rolled; for columns to the left or right, multiply as follows.

Column	Multiplier
Two to the left	×3
One to the left	×2
One to the right	×½
Two to the right	×⅓

For dungeon lairs, with or without treasure, place 1d6 monsters (average 3.5) and modify in the same way. This guide is not meant for the deepest levels (11+), where monster levels and EHDs vary greatly; there, multiply the number by the ratio of dungeon level to EHD (the stat-block document gives the exact EHDs). If the party is larger or smaller than four, scale the numbers in proportion. At least one monster appears in any encounter, which may be very dangerous.

Notes

- **Not in the tables:** Bat, Mule (EHD 0, no attack) and the 91 monsters whose environment is wilderness, water or another plane.
- **Families** (provisional, see `families.json`): giant beetles, hydras and the like are one entry per table with the range of sizes that fall in that band; giants, lycanthropes, golems and living statues are one entry each with the members in parentheses.
- **Dragons** (provisional): one entry, *Dragon (any)*, at level 6, as in the OED tables, because the Arena EHDs for Very Young and Very Old dragons are not reliable (see the stat-block document).